



THE MORNING KICKOFF

📍 FIFA World Cup 26 — United States · Canada · Mexico · Semi-final eve: France–Spain tomorrow, England–Argentina Wednesday

📅 Tomorrow is Bastille Day — and France–Spain in Dallas, 21:00 our time

⚡ Kalshi money piles onto SF1: \$0.8m traded — France 42, Tie 30, Spain 29

📅 Third place confirmed: Saturday in Miami, 23:00 CET — the final Sunday at MetLife

⚡ SEMI-FINAL EVE · BASTILLE DAY IN DALLAS

THE FINAL, ARRIVING A ROUND EARLY.

No football today — just the calm before the collision. France arrive in Dallas as the tournament's only perfect team, six wins from six. Spain arrive with the meanest defence in World Cup history and the receipts from Euro 2024, when Lamine Yamal and Dani Olmo knocked France out at this exact stage. Tomorrow night, 21:00 our time, one of them books the MetLife final.



Kylilan Mbappé — "completely fine", and one win from a third World Cup final on Bastille Day

ALSO THIS MORNING

- ⚡ Mbappé trained and declared himself "completely fine" after the ankle knock from Diop in the quarter-final. Tchouaméni's groin remains France's one real doubt.
- ⚡ England are healthy again: Rice is over the illness that wrecked his quarter-final, and Henderson — broken arm and all — stays in the squad. Messi shook off the knock to the face from Xhaka.
- ★ The Crystal Ball rests today and returns tomorrow morning with the France–Spain call, live market prices and the full factor grid.

INSIDE TODAY'S EDITION

- P2 Both semi-finals previewed in full — plus the history books, from Mexico 86 to Euro 2024
- P3 Golden Boot: Messi 8, Mbappé 8, and the four chasers all play this week
- P4 The road to the final: bracket, third-place match, and your week in football

THIS WEEK (CENTRAL EUROPE)

🇫🇷 France – Spain



Tue 21:00

🇬🇧 England – Argentina



Wed 21:00

FULL PREVIEWS
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SF1 · TOMORROW · BASTILLE DAY · DALLAS



France

VS

Spain



Tue 21:00

Kick-off 3:00 PM ET at the stadium

AT&T Stadium, Dallas

France on Bastille Day: six wins from six, one goal conceded, and Mbappé passing his fitness test with a shrug — "completely fine." The doubt is Tchouaméni's groin. Spain counter with the defence that went six straight games without conceding, a World Cup record, and with Yamal — who ended France's Euro 2024 at this same stage, aged 16. The money leans French at 42%, but 30% sits on the draw: the market smells extra time.

- Yamal against France, the sequel — Euro 2024 semi, Nations League 2025: Spain won both
- Olise's six assists, the tournament high — France's quiet engine beside Mbappé and Dembélé
- Tchouaméni's groin: if he misses out, Spain's midfield trio suddenly looks like the edge



KEY MAN · SPAIN

Lamine Yamal

He ended France's Euro 2024 in this exact fixture, aged 16, and added a brace on them in the 2025 Nations League semi. France still haven't solved him.

SF2 · WEDNESDAY · ATLANTA



England

VS

Argentina



Wed 21:00

Kick-off 3:00 PM ET at the stadium

Mercedes-Benz Stadium, Atlanta

The Hand of God, Beckham's red, Beckham's penalty — and now a World Cup semi-final. Both squads report clean bills of health: Rice has shaken off his illness, Messi the knock to the face from Xhaka, and Henderson stays around the squad with his arm in a cast. Both played 120 minutes Saturday, so recovery is the week's real contest. The market still can't split them: England 37, the draw 33, Argentina 31.

- Bellingham against Messi — four knockout goals versus the man chasing a second straight title
- Kane on 5 goals: three in two games would snatch the Golden Boot from Messi and Mbappé
- Tuchel against Scaloni — the tournament's two calmest benches, and neither has trailed at half-time



KEY MAN · ENGLAND

Harry Kane

Five goals, and the big-stage final third is where he lives. England have never beaten Argentina in a World Cup knockout without him scoring — he intends to keep it that way.



THE HISTORY BOOKS

Four meetings that still echo into this week



Spain

2 – 1

France



Euro 2024 semi · Yamal, Olmo



Spain

5 – 4

France



Nations League 2025 semi



Argentina

2 – 1

England



Mexico 86 · Hand of God



England

1 – 0

Argentina



2002 · Beckham pen

TOMORROW: SF1 — FRANCE-SPAIN, DALLAS, 21:00 CET. THE CRYSTAL BALL RETURNS WITH LIVE MARKET PRICES





8

Lionel Messi

Faces England Wednesday — two games from the Double



8

Kylian Mbappé

Ankle "completely fine" — faces Spain on Bastille Day



7

Erling Haaland

Eliminated — his race ends one goal short



Tie-break: assists, then minutes played. Kane needs three goals in two games to steal it — his 2018 Boot came with a late flurry.

NUMBERS OF THE DAY

6

Olise assists in six games — nobody at this World Cup has more

1

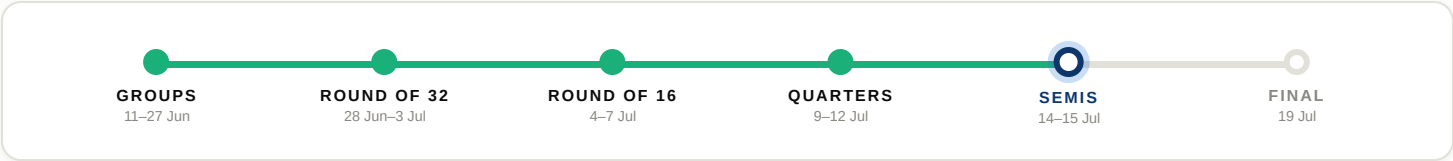
Goals France have conceded in the entire tournament

6

Spain's clean-sheet streak before Friday — the longest in World Cup history

\$0.8m

Already traded on France–Spain on Kalshi by Sunday night



KNOCKOUT BRACKET

Quarter-finals 9–12 July · Semi-finals 14–15 July

QUARTER-FINALS

QF1 · FT · France won 2–0 · · Boston

France

Morocco

QF2 · FT · Spain won 2–1 · · Los Angeles

Spain

Belgium

QF3 · FT · England won 2–1 aet · · Miami

Norway

England

QF4 · FT · Argentina won 3–1 aet · · Kansas City

Argentina

Switzerland

SEMI-FINALS

Tue 14 July · 21:00 · Dallas

France vs Spain

Wed 15 July · 21:00 · Atlanta

England vs Argentina

THE FINAL

Sunday 19 July

MetLife Stadium, New York / New Jersey

YOUR WEEK IN FOOTBALL

Monday 13 July — the final on Sunday 19 July

MON 13 Jul Rest day — semi-final eve	TUE 14 Jul SF1 France–Spain · 21:00	WED 15 Jul SF2 England–Argentina · 21:00	THU 16 Jul Rest day	FRI 17 Jul Rest day	SAT 18 Jul Third place · Miami · 23:00	SUN 19 Jul THE FINAL · MetLife
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See you tomorrow morning.

Next edition: the France–Spain Crystal Ball — our call, the live Kalshi prices, and the full factor grid for Bastille Day in Dallas.

Player photos: Bryan Berlin (CC BY-SA 4.0), 中国新闻社 (CC BY 3.0), via Wikimedia Commons.